

def paged_attention():

⇒ paper that introduced vLLM to paged_attention():

⇒ ~~same~~ idea: Divide the KV cache of a sequence into non-contiguous blocks:

⇒ sharing the system prompt.

⇒ sampling multiple responses per prompt

other vLLM optimizations:

①: kernel to fuse block read and attention.

②: use latest kernels, reduce kernel launch

③: use CUDA graphs to avoid kernel launch overhead (Flash attention, Flash decoding)

use ideas from operating systems (paging) to make full use of memory for dynamic workloads.

Final Summary:

①: Inference is important (actual use, evaluation, reinforcement learning)

②: Different characteristics compared to training

③: Techniques: new architectures (memory-bound, dynamic) quantization, pruning/distillation, speculative decoding

④: ideas from ^{operating} system (vLLM paged Attention)

⑤: New architectures have huge potential (speculative execution) for improvement